

Opposite-colored bishops change priorities

Endgame Technique

THE IDEA

Bishops on opposite colors cannot directly challenge one another's squares. In pure bishop endings this can support blockades and drawing chances. With queens or rooks present, the same color imbalance can strengthen an attack on undefended squares.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A defending bishop may hold a diagonal that blocks passed pawns while the enemy bishop cannot exchange it. If heavy pieces remain, the attacking queen can join the bishop against a king whose matching-color defender is absent.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Why is 'opposite bishops mean draw' misleading?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Pawn placement, king activity, passed pawns, and remaining pieces can make the position winning or losing. Identify a concrete blockade or defensive method before claiming a draw.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Evaluate the whole position, not just the bishops' colors.